

Population density

In 2011, the human population passed seven billion for the first time. Sixty percent of the world's peoples are found in Asia, with China (1.35 billion) and India (1.21 billion) far and away the world's most populous nations. However, people are not spread evenly around the planet, so similar-sized countries can have very different numbers of inhabitants.



LOW DENSITY

The large Asian nation of Mongolia has a population of just 2.67 million, yet it is more than four times the size of the United Kingdom, which has more than 60 million inhabitants. Mongolia's population density is just 4.4 people per sq mile (1.7 people per sq km), with most people living in urban areas.



POPULATION BOOM

Between 1990 and 2010, India's population grew by 40 percent and it now has a sixth of the world's population. There are 200 million more people in India than in the whole of Africa, and experts predict that India may overtake China as the world's most populous country by 2030.

